

Training percentages need denominators

Chess Math

THE IDEA

A score such as 80 percent says little without the number and difficulty of attempts. Record correct solutions, total attempts, time, and whether you found the complete line. Consistent measurement makes study changes easier to judge.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Eight correct out of ten is 80 percent; eighty out of one hundred is also 80 percent, with more evidence. If one set consists of mate-in-one exercises and the other of defensive combinations, the percentages are not directly comparable.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

You solve 18 of 24 puzzles fully. What is your score?

ANSWER AND REASONING

18 divided by 24 equals 0.75, or 75 percent. Separate complete solutions from guessed first moves so the statistic reflects calculation rather than recognition alone.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Compare like with like and keep the sample size.